

Tangram Hint Reference

Puzzles 1-9 | Operator reference document

Each puzzle page shows the participant silhouette and the color solution before the complete preset hint list. Hints move from broad structural guidance toward more specific placement and adjacency information.

Piece legend



1. Orange Triangle



2. Green Square



3. Red Triangle



4. Pink Triangle



5. Yellow Parallelogram



6. Blue Triangle



7. Purple Triangle

Shared hints

1. Try rotating that piece.
2. One piece is in the wrong spot.
3. You are very close - keep going.

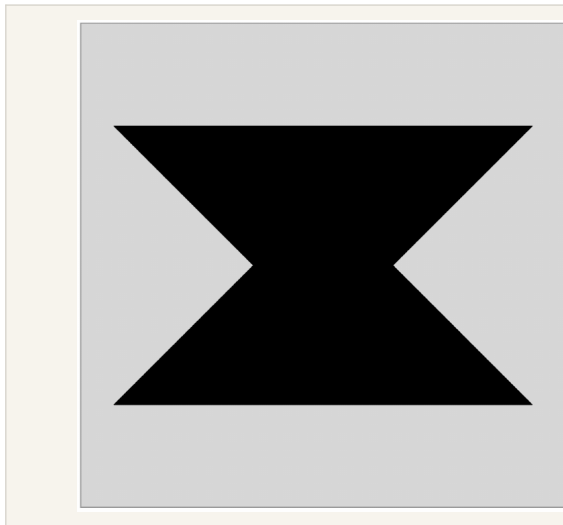
Using this guide

1. Identify the active puzzle number before selecting a hint.
2. Start with a broad structural hint when possible, then move toward exact placement only if needed.
3. The color solution is for the operator's reference and should not be shown to the participant.

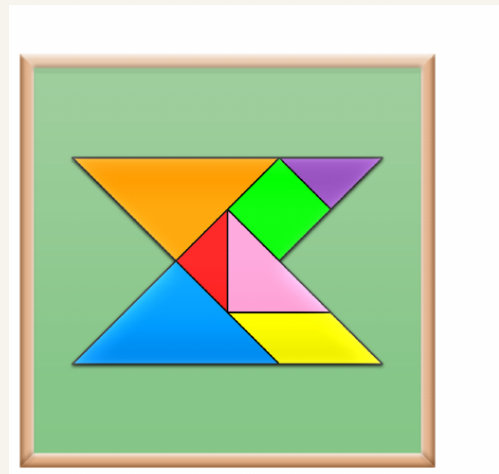
Prepared 23 September 2026

Puzzle 1

20 puzzle-specific hints



Participant silhouette



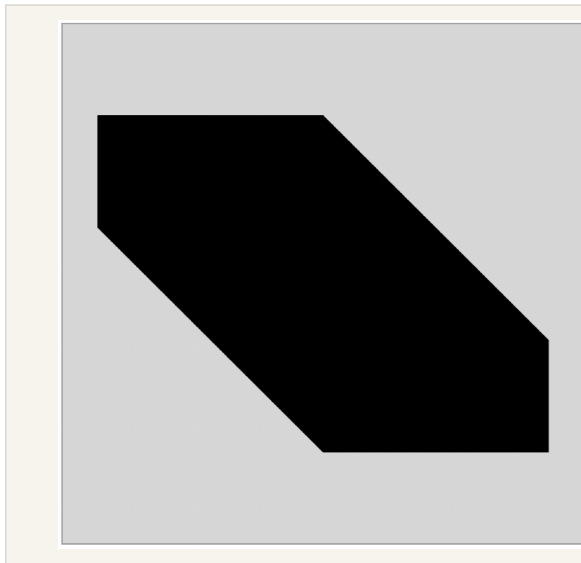
Operator solution

Preset hints

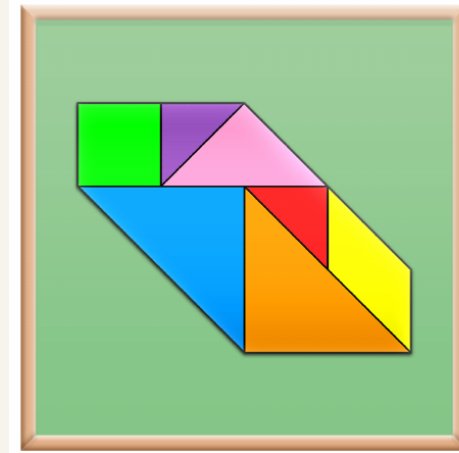
1. Both large triangles belong on the left half of the shape.
2. The orange triangle belongs in the upper-left.
3. The blue triangle belongs in the lower-left.
4. The orange and purple triangles form the flat top edge.
5. The blue triangle and yellow parallelogram form the flat bottom edge.
6. Place the purple triangle in the upper-right corner.
7. Place the yellow parallelogram in the lower-right corner.
8. The green square belongs in the upper-right part of the center.
9. Turn the green square so it sits like a diamond.
10. The pink triangle belongs in the center-right, directly above the yellow parallelogram.
11. The red triangle belongs in the center, directly to the left of the pink triangle.
12. The orange and blue triangles meet at the inward point on the left.
13. The red triangle fits between the two large triangles.
14. The red triangle's vertical edge touches the pink triangle.
15. The red triangle shares one sloping edge with the orange triangle and another with the blue triangle.
16. The green square touches the orange, purple, and pink pieces.
17. The purple triangle's longest edge lies horizontally along the top.
18. The pink triangle's bottom edge lies horizontally against the yellow parallelogram.
19. The yellow parallelogram has horizontal top and bottom edges and leans toward the right.
20. The inward point on the right occurs where the green square's lower corner meets the pink triangle's sloping edge.

Puzzle 2

16 puzzle-specific hints



Participant silhouette



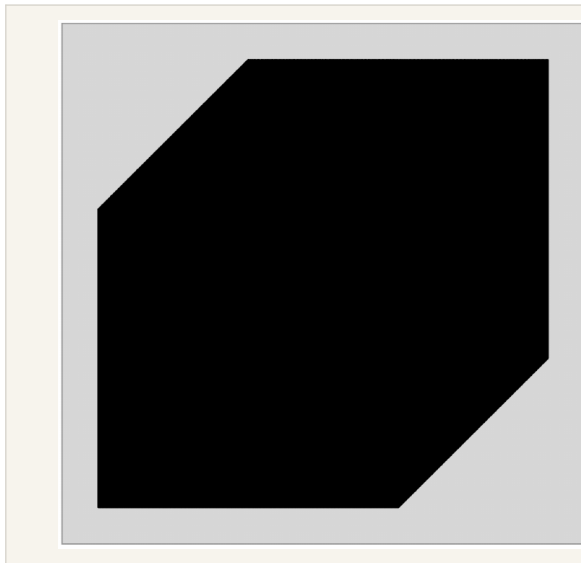
Operator solution

Preset hints

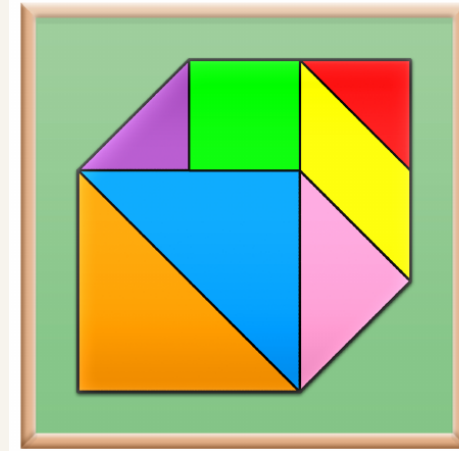
1. Build this shape in two levels: a short top section and a larger lower section.
2. The green square belongs at the far upper-left.
3. Keep the green square upright, with horizontal and vertical edges.
4. The purple triangle goes immediately to the right of the green square.
5. The pink triangle forms the peaked top in the upper middle.
6. The blue large triangle fills most of the lower-left.
7. The orange large triangle fills most of the lower-right.
8. The blue and orange triangles share a vertical edge.
9. The red triangle sits above the orange triangle and below the pink triangle.
10. The yellow parallelogram forms the outer-right side.
11. The green square rests on the blue triangle.
12. The purple triangle shares its vertical edge with the green square and its sloping edge with the pink triangle.
13. The pink triangle's bottom edge touches both the blue and red triangles.
14. The red triangle's vertical edge touches the yellow parallelogram.
15. The orange triangle shares a sloping edge with both the red triangle and the yellow parallelogram.
16. The orange triangle makes the flat bottom edge, while the yellow parallelogram makes the vertical outer-right edge.

Puzzle 3

16 puzzle-specific hints



Participant silhouette



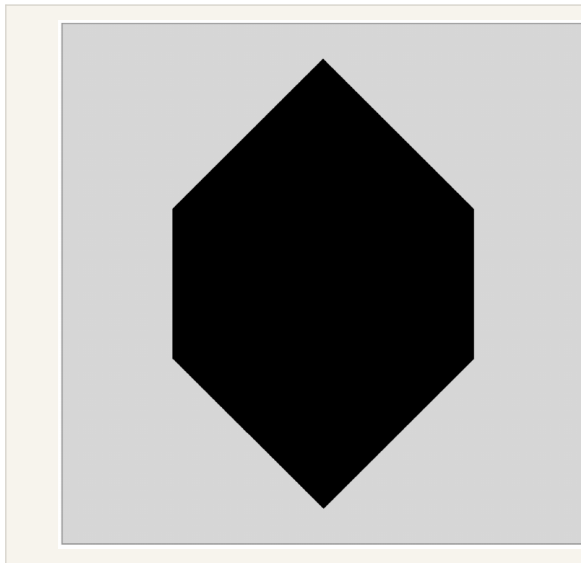
Operator solution

Preset hints

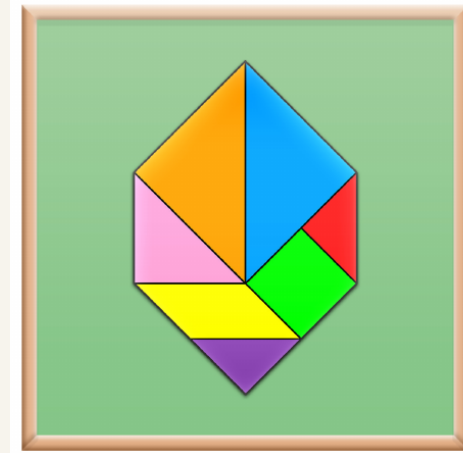
1. Start with the two large triangles forming the lower-left block.
2. The orange large triangle belongs in the bottom-left corner.
3. The blue large triangle belongs directly above and to the right of the orange triangle.
4. The orange and blue triangles share their longest sloping edge.
5. The purple triangle forms the upper-left sloping corner.
6. The green square sits upright along the top, immediately right of the purple triangle.
7. The red triangle fills the upper-right corner.
8. The yellow parallelogram runs diagonally down the right side.
9. The pink triangle forms the lower-right point.
10. The purple triangle rests on the blue triangle and touches the green square.
11. The green square rests on the blue triangle.
12. The green square's right edge touches the yellow parallelogram.
13. The red triangle shares a sloping edge with the yellow parallelogram.
14. The yellow parallelogram sits between the red and pink triangles.
15. The pink triangle's vertical edge touches the blue triangle.
16. The left and bottom outer edges are formed by the orange triangle.

Puzzle 4

16 puzzle-specific hints



Participant silhouette



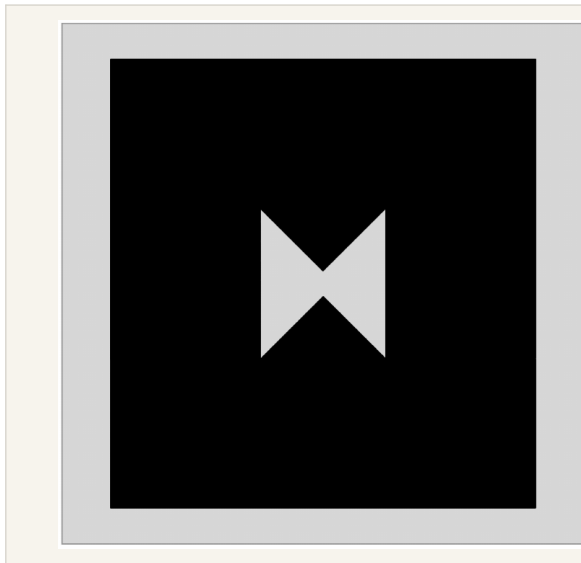
Operator solution

Preset hints

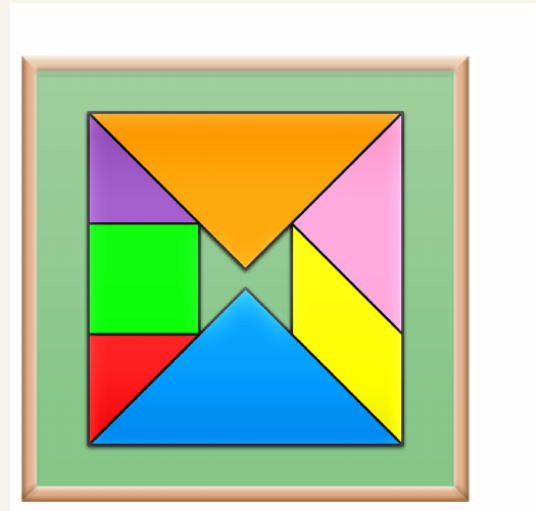
1. The finished outline is a tall diamond-like shape with a point at the top and bottom.
2. The orange and blue large triangles form the upper half.
3. Place the orange large triangle on the upper-left.
4. Place the blue large triangle on the upper-right.
5. The orange and blue triangles share a vertical edge from the top point to the center.
6. The pink triangle forms the middle-left outer side.
7. The red triangle forms the middle-right outer side.
8. Turn the green square so it sits like a diamond in the lower-right middle.
9. The yellow parallelogram lies across the lower-left middle and leans toward the right.
10. The purple triangle makes the bottom point.
11. The pink triangle shares a sloping edge with the orange triangle.
12. The red triangle shares a sloping edge with the blue triangle.
13. The green square touches the blue, red, and yellow pieces.
14. The yellow parallelogram touches the pink triangle along its top edge.
15. The purple triangle's longest edge lies horizontally against the yellow parallelogram.
16. The two large triangles meet at the same center point as the pink, green, and yellow pieces.

Puzzle 5

16 puzzle-specific hints



Participant silhouette



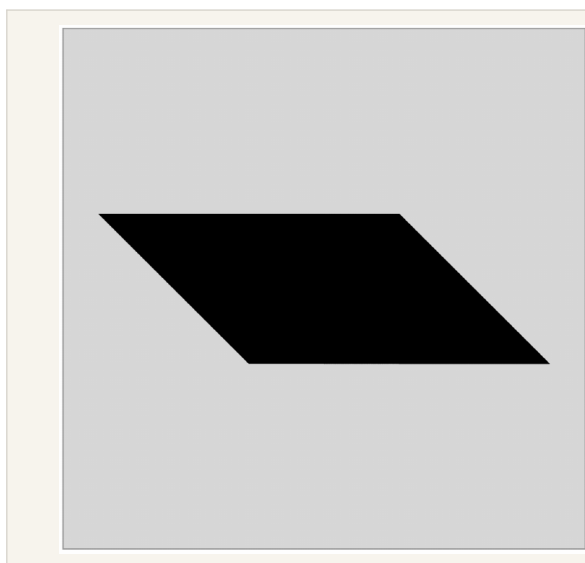
Operator solution

Preset hints

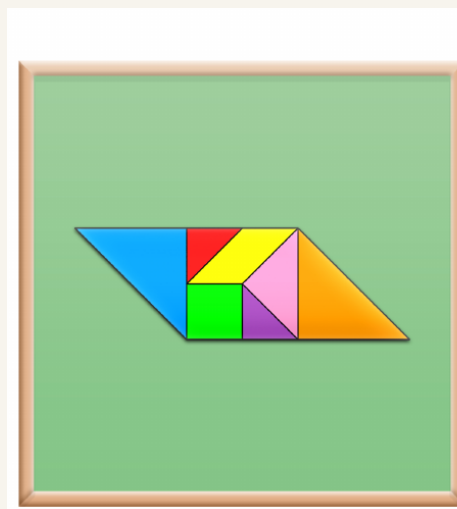
1. Build the flat outside edges of the square first and leave the center openings empty.
2. The orange large triangle spans the top with its point facing downward.
3. The blue large triangle spans the bottom with its point facing upward.
4. The orange triangle's longest edge is the entire top edge.
5. The blue triangle's longest edge is the entire bottom edge.
6. Stack the purple triangle, green square, and red triangle down the left side.
7. The purple triangle belongs in the upper-left corner.
8. Keep the green square upright in the middle-left.
9. The red triangle belongs in the lower-left corner.
10. The pink triangle fills the upper-right side.
11. The yellow parallelogram fills the lower-right side and leans downward to the right.
12. The purple triangle shares a sloping edge with the orange triangle.
13. The red triangle shares a sloping edge with the blue triangle.
14. The pink triangle shares one sloping edge with the orange triangle and another with the yellow parallelogram.
15. The yellow parallelogram shares its lower sloping edge with the blue triangle.
16. The downward orange point and upward blue point define the narrow center between the two openings.

Puzzle 6

16 puzzle-specific hints



Participant silhouette



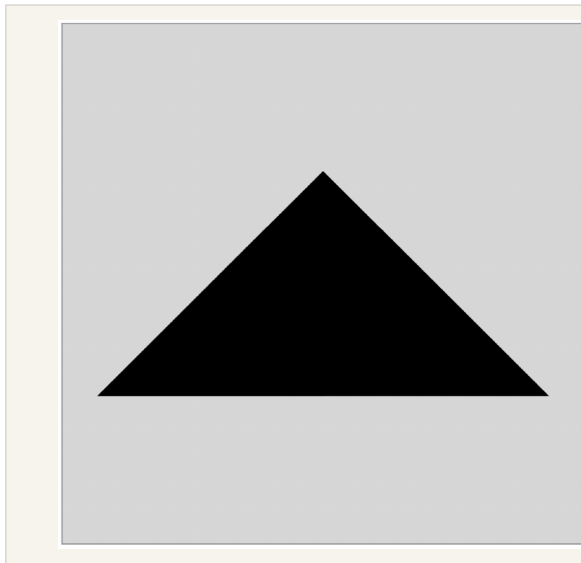
Operator solution

Preset hints

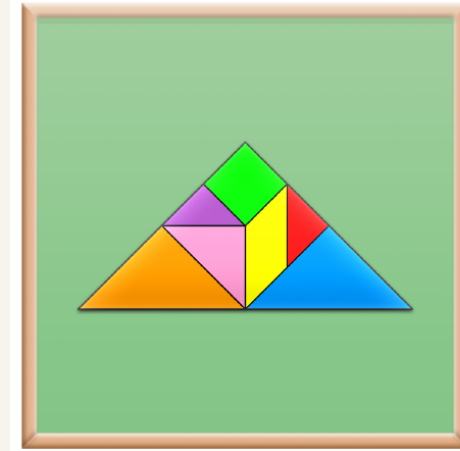
1. This solution is a low horizontal shape with both large triangles at the ends.
2. The blue large triangle forms the far-left end.
3. The orange large triangle forms the far-right end.
4. The blue triangle's top edge is horizontal and its inner edge is vertical.
5. The orange triangle's bottom edge is horizontal and its inner edge is vertical.
6. The five smaller pieces form a rectangular block between the large triangles.
7. The red triangle belongs in the upper-left of the middle block.
8. The green square belongs directly below the red triangle.
9. The yellow parallelogram crosses the upper-middle and leans upward to the right.
10. The pink triangle belongs in the upper-right of the middle block.
11. The purple triangle belongs directly below the pink triangle.
12. The red triangle and green square share the blue triangle's vertical edge.
13. The pink triangle's vertical edge touches the orange triangle.
14. The yellow parallelogram touches the red, green, and pink pieces.
15. The purple triangle fits between the green, pink, and orange pieces.
16. The green square and purple triangle complete the flat bottom of the middle block.

Puzzle 7

15 puzzle-specific hints



Participant silhouette



Operator solution

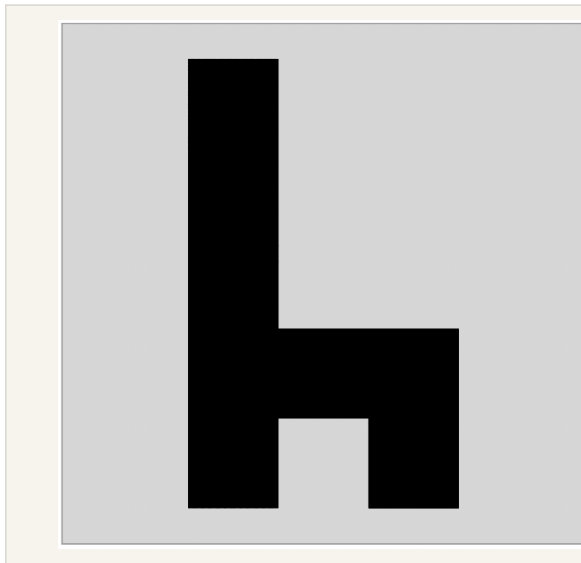
Preset hints

1. The orange and blue large triangles form the two halves of the flat base.
2. Place the orange large triangle on the lower-left.
3. Place the blue large triangle on the lower-right.
4. The orange and blue triangles meet at the center of the bottom edge.
5. The pink triangle sits above the orange triangle in the center-left.
6. The purple triangle sits directly above the pink triangle.
7. Turn the green square like a diamond to make the top point.
8. The yellow parallelogram stands nearly vertical in the center-right.

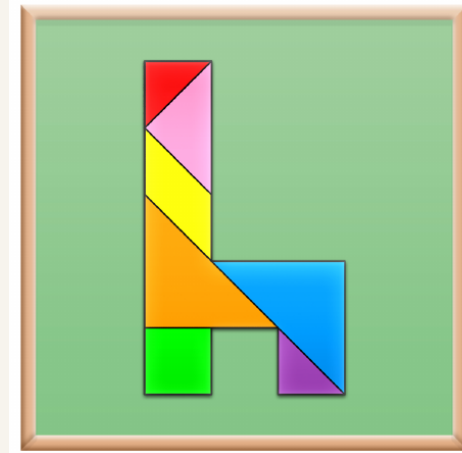
9. The red triangle fills the upper-right slope between the green square and blue triangle.
10. The purple triangle shares a horizontal edge with the pink triangle.
11. The purple triangle shares a sloping edge with the green square.
12. The pink triangle shares a sloping edge with the orange triangle and a vertical edge with the yellow parallelogram.
13. The green square shares a sloping edge with the yellow parallelogram.
14. The red triangle's vertical edge touches the yellow parallelogram.
15. The yellow parallelogram separates the pink triangle from the blue triangle.

Puzzle 8

15 puzzle-specific hints



Participant silhouette



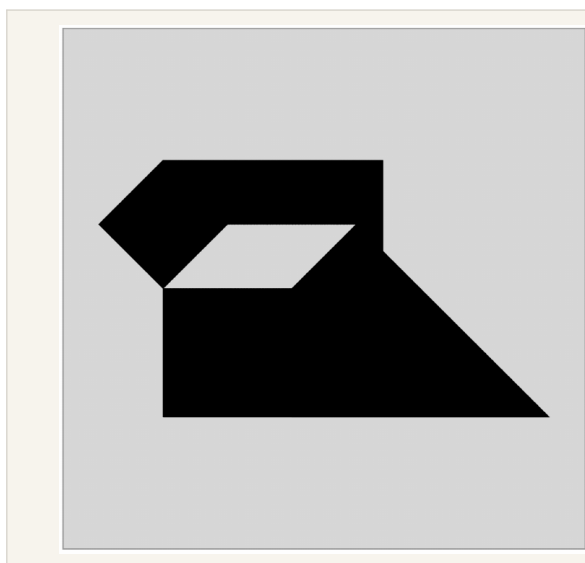
Operator solution

Preset hints

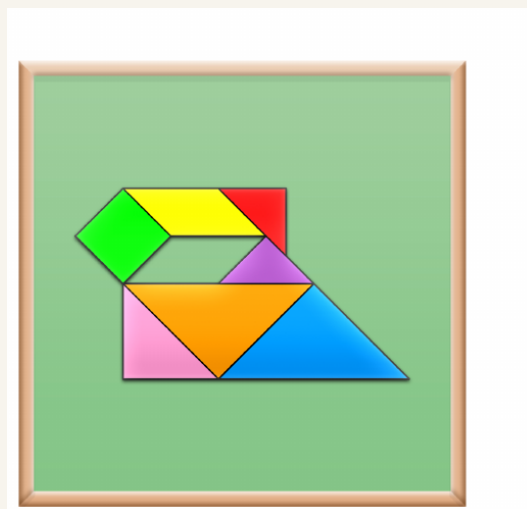
1. Build the tall left column first, then extend the shape to the right.
2. The red triangle belongs at the top-left of the vertical column.
3. The pink triangle belongs at the top-right of the vertical column.
4. The yellow parallelogram sits directly below the red and pink triangles.
5. The orange large triangle forms the lower part of the column and the central horizontal section.
6. The blue large triangle forms the large right-hand section.
7. The green square is the left foot below the orange triangle.
8. The purple triangle is the right foot below the blue triangle.
9. Leave an open rectangular gap between the green and purple feet.
10. The red and pink triangles share a sloping edge.
11. The pink triangle shares its lower sloping edge with the yellow parallelogram.
12. The yellow parallelogram shares its lower sloping edge with the orange triangle.
13. The orange and blue large triangles share a long sloping edge.
14. The green square's top edge touches the orange triangle.
15. The purple triangle shares a sloping edge with the blue triangle.

Puzzle 9

16 puzzle-specific hints



Participant silhouette



Operator solution

Preset hints

1. This solution has a deliberate open space in the upper-middle; do not fill it.
2. The green square sits like a diamond at the far upper-left.
3. The yellow parallelogram forms the nearly horizontal top section.
4. The red triangle belongs at the upper-right end of the yellow parallelogram.
5. The purple triangle sits below the red triangle and points upward.
6. The pink triangle forms the lower-left corner.
7. The orange large triangle points downward in the lower middle.
8. The blue large triangle forms the lower-right end.
9. The pink, orange, and blue triangles form one flat bottom edge.
10. The green square shares an upper sloping edge with the yellow parallelogram.
11. The green square's lower corner meets the pink triangle's upper corner.
12. The yellow parallelogram shares a sloping edge with the red triangle.
13. The purple triangle bridges the red triangle to the lower large triangles.
14. The pink triangle shares a sloping edge with the orange triangle.
15. The orange triangle shares a sloping edge with the blue triangle.
16. The open middle space is bordered by the green square, yellow parallelogram, purple triangle, and orange triangle.